FORGED FATHERS

FORGED FATHERS · MEMBER STARTER PACK

IRON SHARPENS IRON

Training, nutrition and your grocery list. Coached by **Will Carter**.

TRAINING | NUTRITION | GROCERY LIST

WEAREFORGEDFATHERS · @WILLCARTERNLF

START HERE

THE FORGED FATHERS MISSION

Be the best version of yourself for your family.

With this program, the mission is to help fathers be the best version of themselves for their family. We're here to build strength, fitness, discipline, consistency and hold each other accountable.

This isn't about perfection. This is about understanding the season of life you're in and doing what you can, where you are, with what you have.

> Iron sharpens Iron. The goal of this group is to lean on one another when motivation is lacking or you feel like you're struggling.
>
> WILL CARTER

1 YOUR WEEK AT A GLANCE

Your program is based on 3 full body workouts a week that take 30 to 60 minutes. Speed up and shorten rest periods depending on the time you have.

3X
FULL BODY SESSIONS
Resistance training, delivered in TrainHeroic.

8-12K
STEPS PER DAY
Walks count. Get them in where you can.

15-30
MINUTES WITH THE KIDS
Active time with your kids, 3 to 5 times a week.

+
ANY EXTRA HOBBIES
Whatever you have time for. It all adds up.

2 HOW THE PROGRAM RUNS

- **Workouts in TrainHeroic.** Your training lives in the TrainHeroic app. Open it, follow the session, log your sets.
- **WhatsApp group.** The expectation is to share wins, struggles, proud moments and to lean on one another.
- **Weekly check-ins.** Weigh-in, pictures and compliance to the plan, sent to me.
- **Nutrition.** Simple targets to start. Macros if and when you're ready.
- **Group session.** At the end of the 4 weeks we train together, and you can bring your kids (as long as they're old enough to work out safely).
- **MyFitnessPal.** The app I recommend for tracking food when you get there.

DAY ONE

STARTING ASSESSMENT

In order to track progression, I need you to weigh yourself, take photos and write down your goals.

1 YOUR STARTING POINT

WEIGH IN

Same time each week. First thing in the morning after the bathroom works best.

Starting weight / date

TAKE PHOTOS

Front, side and back. Same spot, same lighting, every check-in.

Photos taken (date)

WRITE YOUR GOALS

Below. Be specific. Send them to me with your first check-in.

Sent to Will (date)

2 BE SPECIFIC WITH YOUR GOALS

Answer each one honestly. These are the reasons you'll come back to when motivation is low.

WHAT DO YOU WANT TO ACHIEVE?

WHY DO YOU WANT TO ACHIEVE IT?

WHAT WILL IT CHANGE IN YOUR LIFE WHEN YOU ACHIEVE IT?

WHO WILL BE IMPACTED WHEN YOU ACHIEVE IT?

> **Remember the season you're in.** This isn't about perfection. Set goals you can work toward for weeks and months, not a goal you burn out on in two weeks.

TRAINING

TRAINING EXPECTATIONS

3 full body workouts each week. Your sessions are delivered in TrainHeroic.

1 THE EXPECTATION

The expectation is that you're able to complete the 3 full body workouts each week.

If you can't get all 3 in, that's ok. Aim to go for a walk, do some push ups, sit ups, squats, anything you can do on the day you can't make it to the gym.

TIME

These workouts should hopefully only take **45 minutes**. If you have longer, take your time. If you need to speed it up, get what you can in **30 minutes**.

YOUR SCHEDULE

Feel free to move your training sessions to the days that work best for you. Work, kids and life come first. Fit the sessions around them.

2 ALLOW REST

Your motivation will be high starting this program. Don't overdo it. It's not about how hard you can go for a short period of time, it's about the consistency you can apply for weeks and months on end.

3 MISSED THE GYM? DO THIS INSTEAD

WALK

Get outside. Take the kids or the dog.

PUSH UPS

Sets through the day. Every rep counts.

SIT UPS

A few sets before bed or in the morning.

SQUATS

Bodyweight. In the living room is fine.

4 USING TRAINHEROIC

- Your 3 full body sessions are in the app each week. Open the session for the day and work through it in order.
- Log your weights and reps. That's how we see progression and know when to add weight.
- Supersets show as 1A-1B, 2A-2B. Tempo and RIR are written on each exercise. Page 05 explains both.
- If your gym doesn't have a machine, sub it out. More on that on page 05.

TRAINING

UNDERSTANDING THE TRAINING PRINCIPLES

What you'll see in your TrainHeroic sessions, and how to use it.

1 REPS IN RESERVE (RIR)

This is the number of reps before you reach muscular or technical failure. **3 RIR = 3 reps in the tank**, or 3 reps short of failure.

This takes time to learn and figure out, so don't stress this too much.

RIR QUICK READ

3 RIR	3 more good reps left
2 RIR	Hard, but 2 left
1 RIR	One rep left with good form
0 RIR	Failure. Nothing left

2 TEMPO

In the program you'll see something like **1c, x, 3e, x** tempo.

C
CONCENTRIC
When you exert force. The push or the pull.

E
ECCENTRIC
The stretch. When the weight is returning to starting position.

X
NO PAUSE
No pause between the concentric and the eccentric.

Ideally just use a controlled tempo and don't feel you have to count every rep.

3 SUPERSETS

These are labelled **1A-1B, 2A-2B** and so on. Do the exercises back to back and then take a rest.

The main purpose of a superset is to save time. If you want or have to split them up, you can.

4 WEIGHT PROGRESSION

Only increase weight if you have hit the top end of the rep range. Example: 8-12 reps and you hit 12 by week 2 or 3.

Don't increase weight if you feel you can't maintain form or control of the exercise. Remember the season of life you're in, especially if you haven't worked out in a while. You don't want an injury because you went too hard too fast. Allow the body to adapt and build up steadily.

5 SUBSTITUTIONS

Your gym won't necessarily have the same equipment my gym does, so sub machines out as you need to. A chest press is a chest press. If the machine is similar and you like it, use it. Doing movements in a different order is also fine, as you need to be efficient with your time.

TRAINING

RECOVERY

Training is where you break down. Recovery is where you build back stronger.

7-8 HRS

SLEEP

There is no better recovery tool than sleep. Poor sleep will impact cognitive function, muscle recovery, your hormones and more. Ideally 7-8 hours per night, but in this season that can be difficult. Just do your best to get what you can.

1 GAL

HYDRATION

This is also key. Aim for a gallon of water per day. If you're hungry, sometimes you're just dehydrated. Proper hydration will also aid digestion and keep you regular.

REST

FATIGUE MANAGEMENT

There is a difference between being lazy and being run down or sick. If you feel sick or completely under recovered, take an extra rest day between training. Running yourself further into the ground will not help progression.

1 YOUR WEEKLY TRACKER

Tick it off as you go. Bring it to your weekly check-in.

WEEK OF: _____	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Full body workout (3)							
Walk / push ups / squats							
8-12k steps							
Active time with kids							
1 gallon of water							
Protein every meal							
Hours of sleep							

LAZY OR RUN DOWN?

Just don't feel like it? Go, even if it's the 30 minute version. Sick, wrecked or barely slept for days? Take the extra rest day and tell the group. Nobody will judge you for that.

CONSISTENCY WINS

Weeks and months of steady work beat one big week. A missed day is not a failed week. Walk, push ups, back at it tomorrow.

NUTRITION

NUTRITION MISSION

Nutrition is where the magic happens.

I want you to look at training as the avenue for building strength, getting fit, improving mobility and so on. But nutrition is where the magic happens when it comes to body composition goals.

If you don't commit to consistent application of the nutrition protocols, you won't improve to the level you're capable of.

1 CONSISTENCY

You don't have to be perfect with your nutrition. You're in a busy season of life and sometimes you have to do what you can. I will give you fast and easy on the go options you can use when needed (page 12).

> Don't guilt yourself if you have a slip. Get right back on track as if nothing happened.
>
> WILL CARTER

2 FUELING PERFORMANCE

Even if your goal is fat loss, the goal is not to create the largest deficit possible and be excessively restrictive. The goal is to eat high volume foods that allow you to feel satiated and fuel performance. Once you do this, you'll notice such a huge difference in how you feel.

OATS

Quick oats in the morning.

RICE

Jasmine or basmati.

POTATOES

Sweet or white.

FRUIT + SOURDOUGH

Great carbs to build in.

3 MEAL EXAMPLES, NOT A MEAL TEMPLATE

I will give meal examples but not a meal template, as I want you to eat according to your lifestyle and circumstances. A meal template is strict and will not allow you to make your own decisions as you go.

> **Eating for health is a lifestyle, not a short term fix.**

NUTRITION

NUTRITION PROTOCOL

Simple targets to start. No calorie counting unless you feel confident doing it.

I don't want you to track calories unless you feel confident doing that through a tracking app. We will learn to do this accurately over time. I want you to focus on simple targets to start.

1 GAL	1-2	1-2	1 CUP	1
WATER per day	**PALMS OF PROTEIN** per meal	**FISTS OF VEGGIES** and/or fruit	**OF CARBS** potatoes, rice, oats	**THUMB OF FAT** olive oil, nuts, avocado

1 NUTRITION EXAMPLES

BREAKFAST	2 eggs (scrambled), 1 slice of sourdough bread, ½ an avocado, handful of blueberries.
LUNCH	2 palms of chicken breast, 1 cup of sweet or white potato, 2 fists of veggies of choice.
DINNER	2 palms of 93% ground beef, 2 taco shells, palm of pinto or black beans, lettuce, tomato, ½ an avocado.
SNACK	2 Oikos protein yogurts, handful of blueberries and strawberries, palm of nuts (almonds, cashews, pistachios).

BUILD YOUR OWN PLATE

Start with your palm of protein. Add your fist of veggies or fruit, your cup of carbs, and your thumb of fat. Use the grocery list on page 11 to swap in foods you like.

FAMILY DINNER

Taco night works. So does most of what your family already eats. Keep your protein portion, load up the veggies, and enjoy the table.

NUTRITION

TRACKING, FASTING AND 90/10

Tools you can use when you're ready. None of them have to be perfect to work.

1 TRACKING MACROS

If you feel comfortable tracking macros, reach out to me and I will give you macro numbers to follow. I do advocate for learning to do this and doing it for a period of time, so you gain better awareness of what you're putting into your body and the serving sizes you need.

Once you have done it for a while, you gain good awareness to then eyeball your serving sizes and know that you're close enough. If you want to track macros for a much longer period of time, you absolutely can. Just know you don't have to be absolutely perfect for it to work.

> **The app I recommend: MyFitnessPal.** Huge food database, barcode scanner, and most restaurant chains are already in it. Download it here: **[WILL'S MYFITNESSPAL REFERRAL LINK]**

2 INTERMITTENT FASTING

Some of you might like to use this as a way to limit how much food you can consume. I know some of you like to eat big meals, so intermittent fasting lets you eat larger meals because your eating window is smaller.

You can have an **8 hour window** to eat that suits you, whether that's getting food in earlier in the day or later in the afternoon and evening. This doesn't allow you to eat whatever you want. The goal to eat quality nutrition is still there, but it might help you have better compliance to the plan.

3 GETTING STARTED IN MYFITNESSPAL

1. DOWNLOAD

Use the link above and set up your profile.

2. GET YOUR NUMBERS

Message me and I'll give you macro numbers to enter in the app.

3. LOG HONESTLY

Scan barcodes, weigh what you can, eyeball the rest. Close enough works.

NUTRITION

NO CHEAT MEALS. 90/10.

Enjoy date night and ice cream with your kids, without letting it derail you.

1 WHY I DON'T USE THE TERM

I personally dislike this term, because you don't cheat on your diet. You aren't in a relationship with food. Eating is something we have to do to fuel our bodies, recover and perform better.

I'm a huge advocate for enjoying date nights with your significant other and ice cream with your kids, and I don't want you to have to sacrifice all of that. What I want for you is that you're able to do those things without letting it derail you completely.

90/10

If you want faster, better progression. 90% of your diet is healthy, nutritious foods that support your goals. 10% is for the foods you love, with a level of control.

80/20

If you feel you have more freedom and enjoyment for life this way, that works. 80% nutritious foods, 20% for enjoying the foods you love.

The goal is not for a pizza night to turn into a pizza, ice cream and candy night, but to make the decision on what you really want. Perhaps you don't need the entire pizza. Have 2 slices, then eat protein and vegetables on the side to fill you up and help you stay on track.

2 MAKE THE DECISION

PIZZA NIGHT

2 slices, then protein and vegetables on the side to fill you up.

DATE NIGHT

Pick the one thing you really want, the dessert or the drink. Protein and veggies with the meal.

ICE CREAM WITH THE KIDS

Have it. Be there. Next meal, back on track as if nothing happened.

BIRTHDAY PARTIES

Eat protein before you go so you aren't starving. Enjoy a slice of cake.

NUTRITION

FORGED FATHERS GROCERY LIST

Screenshot it, print it, take it to the store.

Here is a list of the foods I recommend. It doesn't mean you have to stick to this, but typically these are the foods that will help you stay satiated, help you perform and recover, help digestion and ultimately make you feel as good as you can feel.

CARBOHYDRATES

- [ ] Quick oats
- [ ] Jasmine or basmati rice
- [ ] Sweet or white potatoes
- [ ] Sourdough bread
- [ ] Blueberries or raspberries
- [ ] Strawberries
- [ ] Banana (pre workout is ideal if you have them)
- [ ] Apples
- [ ] Grapes
- [ ] Beans

FATS

- [ ] Avocado
- [ ] Cashews
- [ ] Almonds
- [ ] Olive oil
- [ ] Feta cheese
- [ ] Cashew, almond or peanut butter

PROTEINS

PICK 1-3 FAVORITES

- [ ] Chicken breast
- [ ] Chicken thighs (slightly higher in fat)
- [ ] Tuna steak
- [ ] Salmon (higher in fat)
- [ ] Shrimp
- [ ] Cod
- [ ] Filet
- [ ] Sirloin steak
- [ ] Whey protein isolate
- [ ] Egg whites
- [ ] Eggs (higher in fat)
- [ ] Turkey tenderloin

Make sure your picks aren't all higher fat options.

VEGETABLES

PICK THE ONES YOU LIKE

- [ ] Asparagus
- [ ] Zucchini
- [ ] Broccoli
- [ ] Peppers
- [ ] Onions
- [ ] Cabbage
- [ ] Spinach
- [ ] Mushrooms
- [ ] Tomatoes

ON THE GO

FAST AND EASY PROTEIN

For the busy days. Quick options so a crazy schedule doesn't knock you off track.

THE SMOOTHIE

2 scoops whey protein isolate, 1 cup chocolate Fairlife or a similar high-protein milk, a banana or berries. Breakfast in two minutes.

About 60g protein

NIGHT DESSERT

Greek yogurt or an Oikos protein yogurt, berries, a few dark chocolate chips, a crumbled rice cake for crunch. Kids are down and you want something sweet.

About 20-25g protein

READY TO DRINK SHAKES

For a crazy day, a road trip or the car line. Keep a couple in the fridge or truck for emergencies. Real food carries the rest.

About 30g protein

1 PROTEIN CHEAT SHEET

Approximate protein per serving. Meat and fish are cooked weight. A palm is roughly 4 oz. Check your labels, brands vary.

FOOD	SERVING	PROTEIN
Chicken breast	1 palm (4 oz)	**35g**
Chicken thighs	1 palm (4 oz)	**28g**
Turkey tenderloin	1 palm (4 oz)	**32g**
93% ground beef	1 palm (4 oz)	**28g**
Sirloin or filet	1 palm (4 oz)	**32g**
Shrimp	1 palm (4 oz)	**27g**
Cod	1 palm (4 oz)	**26g**
Salmon	1 palm (4 oz)	**28g**
Tuna steak	1 palm (4 oz)	**34g**

FOOD	SERVING	PROTEIN
Whey protein isolate	1 scoop	**25g**
Egg whites	½ cup	**13g**
Eggs	2 large	**12g**
Oikos protein yogurt	1 cup	**15-20g**
Greek yogurt, plain	1 cup	**23g**
Fairlife milk	1 cup	**13g**
Beans, pinto or black	½ cup	**7g**
Beef jerky	1 oz	**10g**
Feta cheese	1 oz	**4g**

Found a quick option that works for you? Share it in the WhatsApp group. Somebody else needs it this week.

REAL LIFE

EATING OUT AND TRAVEL

Date nights, tournaments, work trips. Make the decision on what you really want.

Same approach wherever you are: a palm or two of protein, some veggies or fruit, a sensible portion of carbs. Enjoy the meal, then get right back on track as if nothing happened.

WHERE	GO FOR	WATCH OUT FOR
Date night	Steak, chicken or fish with a veggie and a potato or rice. Decide on the one treat you really want	Bread basket, appetizer, dessert and drinks all at once
Mexican	Chicken or steak fajitas or a bowl, beans, salsa, lettuce	Cheese-heavy combo plates, the second basket of chips
Burger spots	Single or double patty, lettuce, tomato. Small fry if you really want it	Large fries and a shake on top
Sub shops	Double chicken or turkey, all the veggies	Footlong, creamy sauce, chips and cookie
Hotel breakfast	Eggs, oatmeal, fruit, Greek yogurt. Add a shake from your bag	Waffles, pastries, juice
Gas station	Jerky, Fairlife or a ready to drink shake, string cheese, banana or apple	Energy drinks, roller grill, candy
Airport	Protein box, grilled chicken wrap or salad, jerky	Pretzels, cinnamon rolls, sugary coffee

PACK A TRAVEL KIT

- Shaker bottle and whey, pre-portioned
- Jerky or meat sticks
- Nuts, a palm per bag
- One or two ready to drink shakes
- A gallon jug or big water bottle

STUCK ON A MENU?

Snap a photo and post it in the WhatsApp group with what you've eaten so far today. If you're tracking, most chains are already in MyFitnessPal. Search the restaurant name.

And remember: you don't cheat on your diet. Enjoy the ice cream with your kids. Just don't let it derail you.

EVERY WEEK

CHECK-INS AND GROUP ACCOUNTABILITY

Weigh-in, pictures, compliance to the plan. Sent to me every week.

1 WEEKLY CHECK-IN

Copy this into a message, fill it in and send it to me with your pictures. Same day every week.

```
FF CHECK-IN · Week of: ____
Weight: ____   Last week: ____
Pictures: front / side / back sent
Workouts done: __ of 3
Missed days covered (walk, push ups):
__
Avg steps: ____
Water (gallon days): __ of 7
Nutrition compliance: __ of 7 days
Tracking? Y / N   (MyFitnessPal)
WINS
1. _____
STRUGGLES
1. _____
PROUD DAD MOMENT
_____
ONE QUESTION FOR WILL
_____
```

2 GROUP ACCOUNTABILITY

We have a WhatsApp group where the expectation is to share wins, struggles, proud moments and to lean on one another.

> Iron Sharpens Iron.
>
> WILL CARTER

- **Share meals.** If you have found some delicious healthy meals, share them with the group.
- **Ask.** If you're struggling on what to eat and when, ask the group.
- **Lean on each other.** When motivation is lacking, say so. That's what the group is for.
- **Not a competition.** This isn't about who can make the most progress. It's about working together so that everyone achieves great progress.

END OF WEEK 4

Group session together, and you can bring your kids, as long as they're old enough to work out safely.

We're here to help one another succeed. Questions about this pack, your training in TrainHeroic, or your nutrition? Post in the group or message me directly.